

Just prior to leaving the meeting, Mr. W. addressed the committee:

How do you know he's over fifteen pounds? ... How do you know? He could be hollow.... I won't get rid of the dog.

A few days after the meeting, the head of the action committee cornered Mrs. W. while she was walking her dog. He told her in a legalese tone: "Get rid of the dog. You're in violation of our covenant." Later that afternoon, Mrs. W. told her husband what had transpired. She was noticeably upset about the encounter. He advised her to stay calm.

Several weeks later, Mr. W. received a letter that demanded that he remove his dog. It also stated that legal action would be initiated if he did not comply with the dog-related covenant. Two more letters followed. Each contained statements that were even more threatening than the first.

Mr. W. was not impressed with these requests. The author of the letters was the chairman of the action committee. He was also an attorney. But as Mr. W. discovered, the chairman was not licensed to practice law in the state where the complex was located. Thus, Mr. W. "promptly ignored" each of the action committee's demands.

However, Mr. W. and his family began to feel that they were out of place even just vacationing at this condominium complex. Was the action committee using the dog as leverage to evict his entire family? Mr. W. was convinced this was the real issue. He and his family were not what some would consider to be "beautiful people." In contrast, the complex was filled with (in Mr. W.'s parlance) the best-scrubbed condominium owners one could ever imagine.

Mr. W. was growing increasingly angry with the members of the action committee. He felt that its members were going out of their way to be rude to him. He was especially annoyed that the chairman of the committee had embarrassed his wife in front of several other condominium owners, Mr. W. devised a plan.

At a meeting of the condominium owners, at which all the members of the action committee were present, Mr. W. stood up and introduced himself.